Case Study - UK Savoury Snacks

Shopper & Portfolio Analysis

Key Takeaways and Actions on Growth opportunities

Problem statement

Objective: identify the biggest growth opportunities for PepsiCo Savoury by
(a) picking the top focus categories / brands for all retailers and
(b) spotting pack / sub-segment gaps vs competitors – then turn them into clear actions for Acadia Grocers.

Questions:

1. Which categories and brands should drive penetration (how many buy) and AWOP (spend per buyer)?
2. Where are the pack and sub-segment whitespaces vs competition?
3. How does basket structure differ by channel, and what does it mean for Savoury?
4. Where can cross-category / cross-brand deals grow the category?

How I answer it: Sales = Penetration (how many buy) × AWOP (spend per buyer). Each question gets its own slide: Q1 slides 4–5, Q2 slide 6, Q3 slide 7, Q4 slide 8, then the Acadia plan (slide 9) and recommendations (slide 10).

Approach and assumptions

How I structured the problem

1 Frame	2 Clean & check	3 Diagnose	4 Size	5 Prioritise
4 questions + Sales = Penetration × AWOP	1.01m rows → like-for-like weeks	PepsiCo vs market, vs fair share, vs peers	£ gap to PepsiCo's fair share	Impact 50% · ease 30% · fit 20%

Assumptions

Topic	What the data shows	Assumption used
Period	2025 data ends at week 47; weeks 48–52 are the Christmas peak	**Compare 2025 wk 1–47 (TY) with 2024 wk 1–47 (YA), like-for-like**
Online vs in-store	No channel column; four store formats	**Online = E-commerce + Pure play; In-store = Large + Small format**
Acadia Grocers	Sells only through Pure play	**Treated as an online-only retailer**
Penetration & AWOP	No shopper counts in the sales data	**Proxies: share & growth (penetration); spend per basket (AWOP)**
Product level	Segment names are inconsistent	**Analysis at sub-segment level**
Sizing	No forecast data	**£ gap to PepsiCo's fair share = headroom, not a forecast**
Data quality	Data is sanitised; 'Unallocated' format ≈ £5.5k	**Focus on relative gaps and direction; Unallocated removed**

Q1 · Focus categories and brands for penetration and AWOP

Sub-segment performance

Sub-segment	Sales TY	Growth	£ change	PepsiCo share	Share change (points)	Online index
Potato Crisps	£426.4m	-2.9%	-£12.9m	46.4%	-0.2	88
Extruded Snacks	£238.1m	-0.4%	-£0.9m	49.3%	-0.7	119
Nuts & Seeds	£94.7m	+4.0%	£3.6m	**7.2%**	+1.7	84
Tortilla Chips	£68.2m	+2.2%	£1.5m	80.9%	+0.1	78
Crackers	£64.1m	**+17.4%**	£9.5m	**0.0%**	0.0	120
Bread Snacks	£20.4m	**+27.6%**	£4.4m	**0.0%**	0.0	163
Rice Cakes	£20.1m	**+20.7%**	£3.5m	35.4%	**-4.0**	213
F&V Crisps	£17.5m	+8.9%	£1.4m	**4.6%**	-1.4	183
Total market	**£1,077.4m**	**+1.2%**	**£12.4m**	**36.9%**	**-0.9**	**100**

Q1 · PepsiCo brands and their role

PepsiCo brand	Sales TY	Growth	Online growth	Online index	Role
CoastalVale	£129.1m	-0.5%	-0.8%	107	AWOP – core crisps
AmberGrove	£61.5m	+1.8%	+5.9%	64	Defend – tortilla
AlderVale	£35.0m	-5.5%	-1.4%	57	Penetration – nuts & crisps
AmberHearth	£34.7m	-7.6%	+3.7%	104	AWOP – extruded
WestGrove	£14.4m	-16.4%	-2.8%	37	Penetration – nuts & crisps
SilverHearth	£7.1m	**+8.4%**	+24.4%	203	Penetration – rice cakes
HighlandVale	£6.0m	**+20.4%**	+19.3%	183	Penetration – multigrain
WildRidge	£4.5m	**+118.7%**	+53.8%	63	Growth – extruded

Key takeaways

- Win the new shoppers in Nuts and Rice Cakes, both are growing, but PepsiCo is small (only 7% of Nuts). Need to push PepsiCo's nut lines (AlderVale, WestGrove) and SilverHearth rice cakes.
- Getting the existing shoppers to spend more on the Crisps and Extruded snacks that make up 62% of the market and PepsiCo already leads, but sales are flat. So we can sell bigger packs and multipacks of CoastalVale and AmberHearth.
- Crackers and Bread Snacks are the fastest-growing (+17% to +28%), but PepsiCo doesn't sell them, so we can keep these as a long-term option.

Q2 · Pack and sub-segment whitespace

Pack format performance

Pack	Sales TY	% of market	Growth	PepsiCo share	Share chg (pts)	Online index	Price index
Sharing	**£406.9m**	**38%**	+2.5%	**25.6%**	-1.7	83	**118**
Small Multipack	£324.5m	30%	+0.3%	48.5%	-0.3	**144**	107
Medium Multipack	£62.9m	6%	-4.1%	68.4%	-0.7	**154**	104
Large Multipack	£39.9m	4%	-6.9%	67.2%	+1.6	**228**	103
Grabs	£61.6m	6%	+4.8%	49.6%	-1.2	8	97
Standards	£68.9m	6%	+0.6%	32.3%	+1.8	41	80
Total market	**£1,077.4m**	**100%**	**+1.2%**	**36.9%**	**-0.9**	**100**	**107**

Biggest PepsiCo gaps (sub-segment × pack)

Sub-segment	Pack	Pack sales	PepsiCo share in pack	PepsiCo share in sub-segment	Fair share index	£ headroom
Potato Crisps	Sharing	**£162.9m**	**20.1%**	46.4%	43	**£42.9m**
Extruded Snacks	Grabs	£13.6m	0.0%	49.3%	0	£6.7m
Rice Cakes	Sharing	£14.5m	26.9%	35.4%	76	£1.2m

Key takeaways

- Sharing bags: the biggest pack (38% of sales), but PepsiCo has only 26% and is priced 18% higher.
- Biggest gap: crisp sharing bags, where PepsiCo has 20% vs 46% in crisps overall, worth about £43m.

Q3 · Basket structure by channel

Sales by channel

Channel	Sales TY	Growth	Share of growth	PepsiCo share	Share chg (pts)
Online	**£183.6m**	**+5.8%**	**82%**	36.3%	-0.9
In-store	£893.8m	+0.3%	18%	37.0%	-0.8
Total Market	**£1,077.4m**	**+1.2%**	**100%**	**36.9%**	**-0.9**

% of baskets by basket value

Channel	< £20	£20–£60	> £60
Convenience	**94%**	5%	1%
Supermarkets	62%	29%	10%
Online	2%	36%	**62%**

Shopper and nuts & snacks baskets: in-store vs online

Measure	In-store / offline	Online	Online index
Families with kids (% of shoppers)	41%	52%	**127**
Main-shop mission (% of shoppers)	43%	79%	**184**
Baskets with nuts & snacks (CSN)	23%	49%	**213**
£ per nuts & snacks basket	£2.80	£4.20	**150**

Key takeaways

- Growth: online is up 5.8% and delivers 82% of the market's growth
- Bigger baskets: 62% of online baskets are over £60 (vs 1% in convenience)
- More snacks: online baskets are twice as likely to include nuts and snacks, with 1.5x the spend

Q4 · Cross-category / cross-brand deals

Bought…	Owner	Co- bought	Owner	% of buyers	Deal type
All Nuts	Category	Potato Crisps Sharing	Category	**80%**	Cross-category
All Nuts	Category	Small multipack crisps	Category	**78%**	Cross-category
All Nuts	Category	Extruded Sharing	Category	57%	Cross-category
WestGrove	PepsiCo	AlderVale	PepsiCo	**51%**	PepsiCo portfolio
AlderVale	PepsiCo	AmberGrove	PepsiCo	40%	PepsiCo portfolio
CopperTrail	PepsiCo	SunnyCrown	Valley Trail Foods	54%	PepsiCo vs competitor
AmberHearth	PepsiCo	AmberGrove	PepsiCo	**55%**	PepsiCo portfolio

Key takeaways

- Nuts + crisps: 8 in 10 nuts buyers also buy sharing crisps, so bundle them.
- Combo deals: 40–55% already buy two PepsiCo brands, so offer mix-and-match deals online
- Popcorn gap: 54% of CopperTrail buyers buy a competitor’s popcorn, which PepsiCo doesn’t offer (segment −1.4%, so a watch-point)

Acadia Grocers · actions

Acadia vs other online retailers

Measure	Acadia	Other online retailers	Gap (pts)
Market growth	**+15.5%**	+4.1%	+11.5
PepsiCo share	**24.8%**	38.6%	**-13.7**
PepsiCo growth	+4.6%	+2.9%	+1.7

Actions

- Fill gaps: more PepsiCo Extruded and Tortilla sharing packs
- Match shoppers: add nuts and healthier snacks, a nuts + crisps deal, and top search spots
- Worth: about £4.2m extra sales

Sub-segment mix and PepsiCo share: Acadia vs other online

Sub-segment	Acadia mix	Other online mix	Mix index	PepsiCo share Acadia	PepsiCo share other online	Gap (pts)
Potato Crisps	26.0%	37.5%	69	47.8%	49.6%	-1.7
Extruded Snacks	17.9%	27.0%	66	38.1%	49.9%	**-11.8**
Nuts & Seeds	11.8%	6.8%	**173**	2.8%	4.7%	-2.0
F&V Crisps	7.5%	1.6%	**464**	5.6%	3.3%	+2.3
Rice Cakes	6.5%	2.7%	**237**	26.0%	37.9%	**-11.9**
Bread Snacks	5.7%	2.2%	**256**	0.0%	0.0%	0.0
Tortilla Chips	4.8%	5.2%	92	47.0%	72.5%	**-25.4**

Key Recommendations

Priority	Actions	Lever	£ headroom
High	Win Potato Crisps sharing: range, price-pack, online visibility	Penetration	£42.9m
High	Online multipack trade-up + nuts & crisps bundles	AWOP	not sized
Medium	Close online gaps vs in-store (Tortilla sharing, Nuts)	AWOP	£2.5m
Medium	Acadia plan: sharing range, nuts, bundles, search	Penetration	£4.2m
Medium	Scale PepsiCo nuts via the crisps cross-buy	Penetration	£28.0m
Low	Explore Crackers / Bread Snacks entry	Penetration	£23.7m

Next steps

- Include more crisp sharing bags and online multipacks, the biggest gaps with brands PepsiCo already has
- Run an 8-week nuts + crisps deal at Acadia; if it works, roll it out everywhere